

Men's Ballon d'Or

France Football created the Ballon d'Or in 1956. Eligibility rules changed over time: the award was initially limited to European players, opened to players of any nationality at European clubs in 1995, and became fully global in 2007. From 2010 through 2015 it was presented jointly with FIFA.

Men's Ballon d'Or winners, 1956 to present

Year	Winner	National team
2025	Ousmane Dembélé	France
2024	Rodri	Spain
2023	Lionel Messi	Argentina
2022	Karim Benzema	France
2021	Lionel Messi	Argentina
2020	Not awarded	—
2019	Lionel Messi	Argentina
2018	Luka Modrić	Croatia
2017	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal

Year	Winner	National team
2016	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal
2015	Lionel Messi	Argentina
2014	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal
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2012	Lionel Messi	Argentina
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2010	Lionel Messi	Argentina
2009	Lionel Messi	Argentina
2008	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal
2007	Kaká	Brazil
2006	Fabio Cannavaro	Italy
2005	Ronaldinho	Brazil
2004	Andriy Shevchenko	Ukraine
2003	Pavel Nedvěd	Czech Republic
2002	Ronaldo	Brazil
2001	Michael Owen	England

Year	Winner	National team
2000	Luís Figo	Portugal
1999	Rivaldo	Brazil
1998	Zinedine Zidane	France
1997	Ronaldo	Brazil
1996	Matthias Sammer	Germany
1995	George Weah	Liberia
1994	Hristo Stoichkov	Bulgaria
1993	Roberto Baggio	Italy
1992	Marco van Basten	Netherlands
1991	Jean-Pierre Papin	France
1990	Lothar Matthäus	West Germany
1989	Marco van Basten	Netherlands
1988	Marco van Basten	Netherlands
1987	Ruud Gullit	Netherlands
1986	Igor Belanov	Soviet Union
1985	Michel Platini	France

Year	Winner	National team
1984	Michel Platini	France
1983	Michel Platini	France
1982	Paolo Rossi	Italy
1981	Karl-Heinz Rummenigge	West Germany
1980	Karl-Heinz Rummenigge	West Germany
1979	Kevin Keegan	England
1978	Kevin Keegan	England
1977	Allan Simonsen	Denmark
1976	Franz Beckenbauer	West Germany
1975	Oleg Blokhin	Soviet Union
1974	Johan Cruyff	Netherlands
1973	Johan Cruyff	Netherlands
1972	Franz Beckenbauer	West Germany
1971	Johan Cruyff	Netherlands
1970	Gerd Müller	West Germany
1969	Gianni Rivera	Italy

Year	Winner	National team
1968	George Best	Northern Ireland
1967	Flórián Albert	Hungary
1966	Bobby Charlton	England
1965	Eusébio	Portugal
1964	Denis Law	Scotland
1963	Lev Yashin	Soviet Union
1962	Josef Masopust	Czechoslovakia
1961	Omar Sívori	Italy
1960	Luis Suárez	Spain
1959	Alfredo Di Stéfano	Spain
1958	Raymond Kopa	France
1957	Alfredo Di Stéfano	Spain
1956	Stanley Matthews	England

Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Lionel Messi 	8
2009, 2010, 2011, 2012, 2015, 2019, 2021, 2023	
Cristiano Ronaldo 	5
2008, 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017	
Johan Cruyff 	3
1971, 1973, 1974	
Michel Platini 	3
1983, 1984, 1985	
Marco van Basten 	3
1988, 1989, 1992	
Alfredo Di Stéfano 	2
1957, 1959	
Franz Beckenbauer 	2
1972, 1976	
Kevin Keegan 	2
1978, 1979	
Karl-Heinz Rummenigge 	2
1980, 1981	

Ronaldo  1997, 2002	2
Stanley Matthews  1956	1
Raymond Kopa  1958	1
Luis Suárez  1960	1
Omar Sívori  1961	1
Josef Masopust  1962	1
Lev Yashin  1963	1
Denis Law  1964	1
Eusébio  1965	1

Bobby Charlton  1966	1
Flórián Albert  1967	1
George Best  1968	1
Gianni Rivera  1969	1
Gerd Müller  1970	1
Oleg Blokhin  1975	1
Allan Simonsen  1977	1
Paolo Rossi  1982	1
Igor Belanov  1986	1

Ruud Gullit  1987	1
Lothar Matthäus  1990	1
Jean-Pierre Papin  1991	1
Roberto Baggio  1993	1
Hristo Stoichkov  1994	1
George Weah  1995	1
Matthias Sammer  1996	1
Zinedine Zidane  1998	1
Rivaldo  1999	1

Luís Figo



2000

1

Michael Owen



2001

1

Pavel Nedvěd



2003

1

Andriy Shevchenko



2004

1

Ronaldinho



2005

1

Fabio Cannavaro



2006

1

Kaká



2007

1

Luka Modrić



2018

1

Not awarded



2020

1

Karim Benzema

1



2022

Rodri

1



2024

Ousmane Dembélé

1



2025



Notes

- Lev Yashin remains the only goalkeeper to win the men's award.
- George Weah became the first African winner in 1995.
- Luka Modrić won in 2018.
- The 2020 award was cancelled.
- Ousmane Dembélé won the 2025 award.



References & review

Status: review

Last reviewed: 23 July 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>)
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.